

AVEX ESP models

1) Activations (easy - low hanging fruit)

Produce activation statistics and compare different models and dataset.

Models: the 4 transformer models

Dataset: EarthSpeciesProject/NatureLM-audio-training, split by source_dataset

Step 1: collect all residual stream activations (embeddings, post-layer 0 .. 11) for a significant chunk of NatureLM-audio-training; each dataset item will be a 13 x 513 x 768 torch array. Keep meta-data labels, in particular file_name/metadata (flatten if possible) / Source_dataset / id / output / task

Q: where do we store activations?

Step 2: measure activation statistics:

Activation L2 norms

Singular values

PCA alignment

Intrinsic dimensionality

Compare across layers and models

Either use all activations, or mean-pool activations to get one vector per item

Compare nature sounds to other sound

Step 3: specific cases

- Look at dynamics of activations upon addition of white noise / pink noise at different levels; mean-pool activation of a single dataset and repeat for several datasets; find “noise” subspace (Sid)
- Add two audio sources together; dynamics of representations, how do they “bridge” between one and the other

Other ideas: barycenter of each species...

do we see hierarchical representations? See Victor Veich paper

2) Probes (medium) + attribution (harder)

Train probes at each layer to separate, say, two species of birds; then apply attribution techniques to recover which patterns they are sensitive to

Step 1: identify in EarthSpeciesProject/NatureLM-audio-training subsets that correspond to 2 (or more) distinct species. They need to have a substantial amount of items for each species.

Step 2: train probes (linear probes to start with) to separate one vs the other. Evaluate accuracy across layers.

Step 3: use attribution methods to recover which input patches they rely on. More details coming soon.

Step 4: probe for different separation, for example:

Class: Aves / Mammalia

Order: Passeriformes / Charadriiformes / Piciformes / Strigiformes

Species: a lot

Can we find directions corresponding to say, animal vs music, Aves vs Mammalia, etc.

Do we see hierarchical geometry corresponding to representations?

Apply the gaussian blob fit?

Note: can do that with activation centroids too! (probably easier)

3) Dictionary learning / SAEs (hard)

Might do later, but not priority.